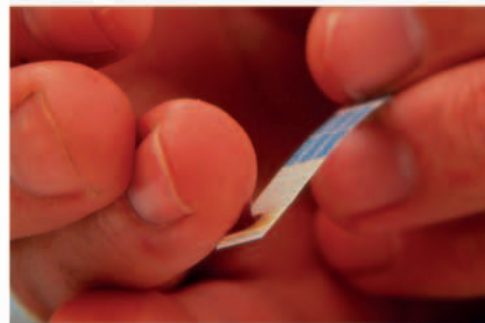


TESTING BLOOD

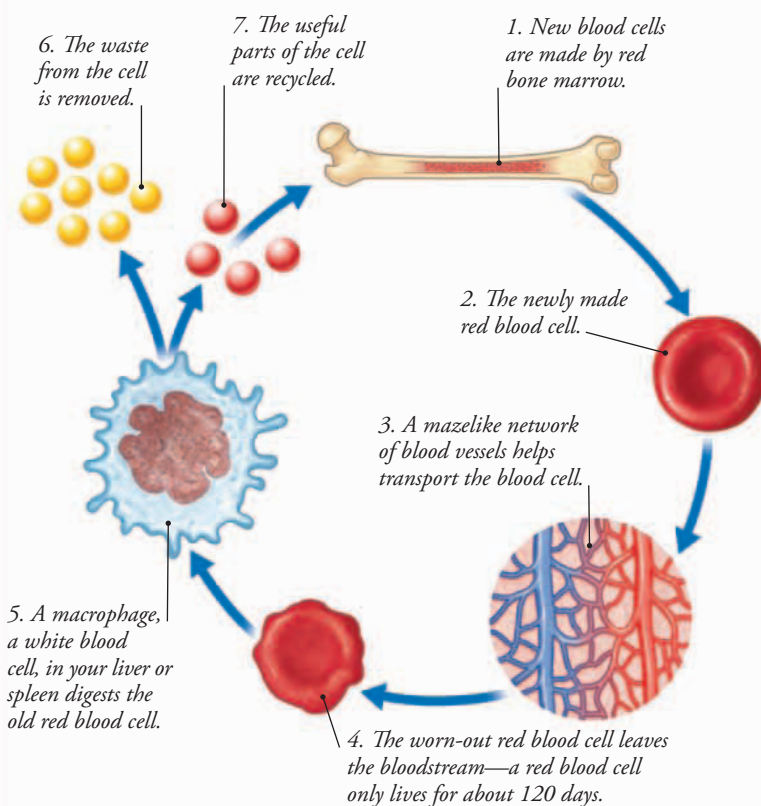
Doctors often use blood tests to detect anything unusual in your blood, which might explain why you are feeling unwell. Here, a patient's finger has been pricked using a lancet and a sample of blood is collected on a test strip that detects specific substances.



Red blood cells carry oxygen from your lungs to every cell in your body.

MAKING RED BLOOD CELLS

All blood cells are made in red bone marrow. When you are young, nearly all bones contain red bone marrow. In adults, this is found only in the skull bones, ribs, shoulder blades, hipbones, and the ends of long bones.



Platelets help heal a wound by forming a plug and by making blood clot.